



Entertainment & Fun

Beijing Expat Bars: Where Foreigners Actually Hang Out (2026)

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Beijing Expat Bars: Where Foreigners Actually Hang Out (2026)

Tired of tourist traps? Here are the real bars where Beijing's expat community gathers -- with actual addresses you can put into your map app. These are the spots locals and long-term foreigners actually go to, not the places listed in generic travel guides.

Craft Beer & Breweries

* Great Leap Brewing #12 (大跃啤酒)

* Doujiao Hutong #6, Dongcheng District (东城区豆角胡同6号) 12:00-24:00 | ¥40-60/pint

Beijing's original craft brewery in a hutong courtyard. The Honey Ma Gold and Pale Ale

#6 are legendary. Gets packed on weekends. Outdoor seating in summer is the best vibe

in Beijing.

* Website



* Slow Boat Brewery (悠航鲜啤)

* 56 Dongsì Shítiao, Dongcheng District (东城区东四十条56号) 16:00-00:00 | ¥45-65/pint

Award-winning IPAs and the best burger in Beijing (seriously). The Monkey Fist IPA won multiple international awards. Cozy interior with exposed brick.

* Website

* Jing-A Brewing Taproom (京A)

* Xingfucun Zhonglu, Building 19, Chaoyang District (朝阳区幸福村中路19号楼)

11:00-00:00 | ¥45-65/pint Best outdoor terrace in Beijing. Try the Flying Fist IPA and

Airpocalypse Double IPA. Great food menu too -- the pulled pork sandwich is solid.

Multiple locations but this is the OG.

* Website

* Arrow Factory Brewing (箭厂啤酒)

* 9 Jianchang Hutong, Dongcheng District (东城区箭厂胡同9号) 16:00-23:00 | ¥40-55/pint

Hidden gem in a quiet hutong near the Drum Tower. Small but quality-focused. The



Stout and Belgian Wit are excellent. Feels like a neighborhood secret.

* Website

* Panda Brew (熊猫精酿)

* 62 Dongsibei Dajie, Dongcheng District (东城区东四北大街62号) 14:00-00:00 |

¥35-50/pint Chinese-owned craft brewery with nationwide distribution. The taproom has 20+ beers on rotation. Try the Honey Ale and Tangerine Wheat. Good for groups.

* Website

Cocktail Bars & Speakeasies

* Capital Spirits (首都烈酒)

* 3 Qianliang Hutong, Dongcheng District (东城区钱粮胡同3号) 19:00-02:00 |

¥60-90/cocktail China's first baijiu cocktail bar. Don't be scared -- the bartenders transform baijiu into incredible cocktails. The "Baijiu Sour" converts skeptics. Tiny space, always buzzing. Reservations recommended.



* Website

* The Bar at The Opposite House (瑜舍)

* Building 1, Taikoo Li Sanlitun, Chaoyang District (朝阳区三里屯太古里1号楼) 17:00-01:00

| ¥80-120/cocktail Luxury hotel bar with stunning minimalist design. The cocktails are pricey but exceptional. Great for dates or impressing clients. The lobby bar has live DJ on weekends.

* Website

* Migas (米家思)

* 6/F, Nali Patio, 81 Sanlitun Road, Chaoyang District (朝阳区三里屯路81号那里花园6层)

18:00-02:00 | ¥70-100/cocktail Rooftop bar with incredible views of Sanlitun.

Spanish-inspired cocktails and tapas. The Sunday brunch is legendary among expats.

Summer rooftop parties are unmissable.

* Website



* Janes & Hooch

* 4 Gongti Beilu, Chaoyang District (朝阳区工体北路4号) 19:00-02:00 | ¥65-95/cocktail

Industrial-chic cocktail bar near Workers' Stadium. Excellent Old Fashioned and Negroni. The bartenders are serious about their craft. Gets lively after 11 PM on weekends.

* Amap

Live Music & Dive Bars

* DDC (Dusk Dawn Club 黄昏黎明俱乐部)

* 14 Shanlao Hutong, Dongcheng District (东城区山老胡同14号) 20:00-02:00 | ¥50-80

(cover varies) Beijing's best live jazz and indie music venue in a renovated hutong. Acts range from local jazz trios to touring international bands. The sound system is excellent for the intimate space.

* Website



* Temple Bar (寺庙酒吧)

* 206 Gulou Dong Dajie, Dongcheng District (东城区鼓楼东大街206号) 19:00-02:00 |

¥30-50/beer Dive bar with character near the Drum Tower. Cheap drinks, loud music, and a crowd of regulars who've been coming for years. The rooftop has a great view of the Drum Tower at night.

* The Beijinger

* The Den

* 4 Gongti Xilu, Chaoyang District (朝阳区工体西路4号) 18:00-02:00 | ¥40-60/beer Irish pub

that's been an expat institution for 20+ years. Sports on multiple screens, decent pub grub, and a reliable crowd. Wednesday quiz night is competitive.

* The Beijinger

* Paddy O'Shea's

* 28 Dongsì Shítiao, Dongcheng District (东城区东四十条28号) 16:00-02:00 | ¥40-60/beer

The quintessential Irish pub in Beijing. Live sports, Guinness on tap, and a warm



atmosphere. The go-to spot for watching Premier League matches with fellow expats.

* Website

Insider Tips:

* Hutong bars are best found by walking around -- many have no sign, just a red door

* Sanlitun gets touristy after midnight -- locals move to Gulou or Wudaokou

* Happy hour (5-8 PM) at most bars: 2-for-1 cocktails or ¥30 beers

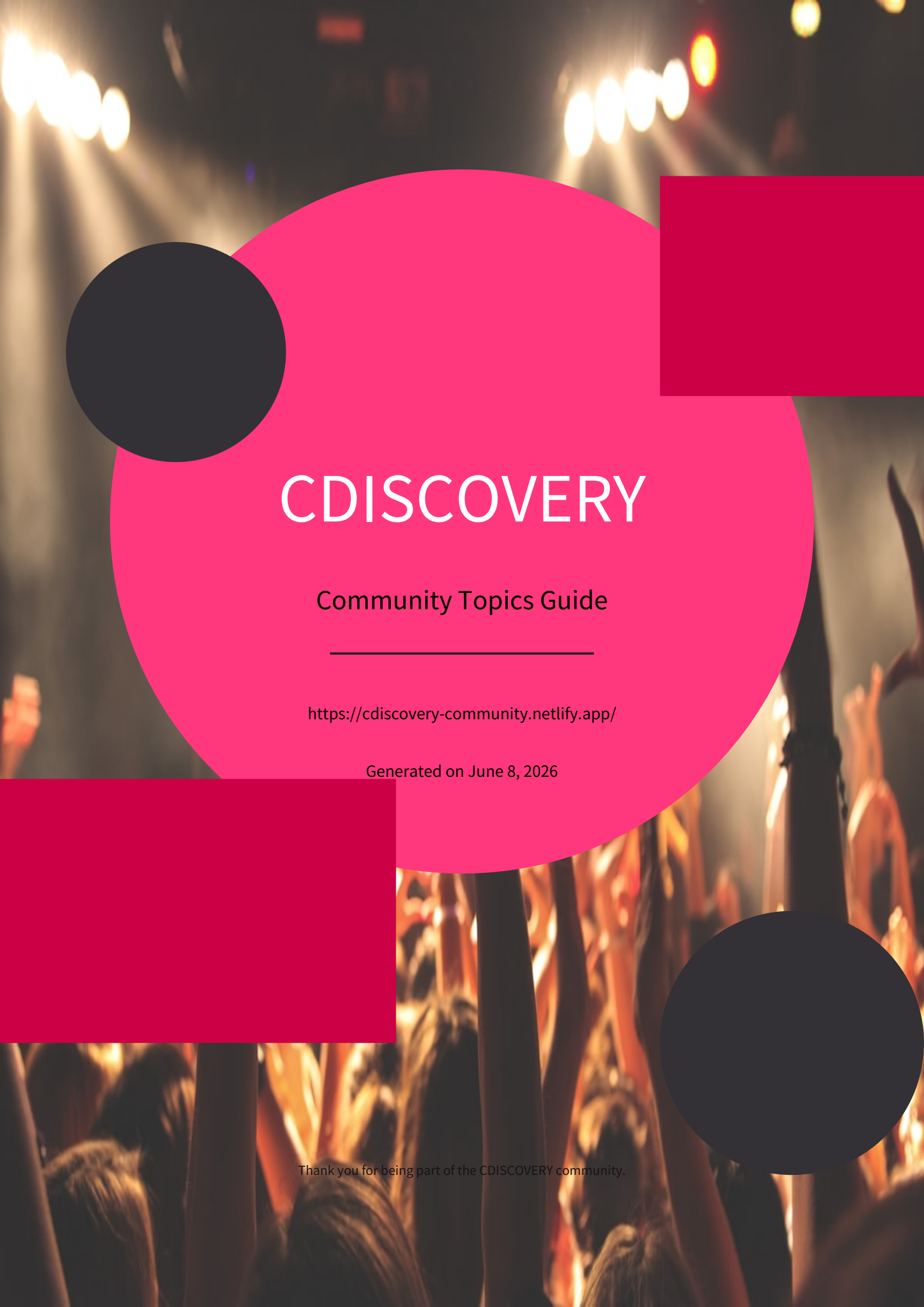
* Use

* Amap (高德地图)

* to find hidden bars -- search "酒吧" + your area

* WeChat groups: search "Beijing expats" or "Beijing nightlife" for curated event listings

Sources: Sources: [The Beijinger](https://www.thebeijinger.com/blog) • [Great Leap Brewing](https://www.greatleapbrewing.com) • [Slow Boat](https://www.slowboatbrewing.com) • [Jing-A](https://www.jingabrewing.com)

The background of the cover is a photograph of a crowd at a concert or festival, with many hands raised in the air. The scene is lit with warm, golden light, possibly from stage lights. Overlaid on this background are several geometric shapes: a large pink circle in the center, a smaller dark grey circle in the top left, a pink rectangle in the top right, a pink rectangle in the bottom left, and a dark grey circle in the bottom right.

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